Strategic Action Plan: Journal Upgrade

Upgrading the BUBT Suicide-Risk-Detection Capstone into a Q1 Journal Publication

Target Horizon: 8 Weeks (Q3 2026) **Primary Venue:** Journal of Big Data (Q1) **Status:** Active Plan Re-scoping

1. STRATEGIC CONTEXT & OBJECTIVES

This strategic action plan transitions the completed BUBT capstone thesis into a high-impact **Q1 journal submission**. Moving beyond the initial 14-day conference paper roadmap, this expanded trajectory incorporates comprehensive literature consolidation, dataset reconciliation, and robust statistical validation required by top-tier journals.

Key Discovery Highlights:

- **Literature Expansion:** Merging individual review repositories (`komol/` and `tomal/`) yields 14–16 unique, high-value papers beyond the thesis's original 42 references.
- **Dataset Reconcilation:** Identified a ~180-record gap between the raw CSV (1,797 rows) and the analyzed thesis dataset (1,617 rows) that requires systematic reconciliation.
- **Methodological Novelty:** Leverages unsupervised clustering across structured, missing-heavy newspaper records rather than conventional text mining.

2. JOURNAL TARGET EVALUATION

Journal Name	Quartile / IF	Core Fit & Alignment	Strategic Role
Journal of Big Data (Springer)	Q1 / IF 10.8	Direct alignment with imputation × clustering benchmarking on complex data. High methodological rigor match.	**Primary Target**
BMC Psychiatry (Springer/BMC)	Q1 / IF ~3.8	Strong epidemiological and public-health relevance. Precedent existing in thesis citations (ref [24]).	**First Fallback**
Scientific Reports (Nature Portfolio)	Q1 / IF 4.9	Broad safety net accepting solid computational and data science methodologies.	**Secondary Fallback**

⚠️ Priority Action: Team Alignment Resolution

Recent planning notes indicate potential scope confusion regarding whether to initiate a fresh study (region/reason focused) or upgrade the completed thesis.
Resolution Directive: Anchor firmly to the finished thesis scope. The missingness-imputation-clustering benchmark is fully executed; restarting fresh data collection would discard existing valid research artifacts.

3. TARGETED REPOSITORY ARCHITECTURE

```
suicide-risk-detection/
├── paper/
│   ├── main.tex                # Primary submission template (Journal of Big Data)
│   ├── refs.bib                # Merged 56-58 entry bibliography
│   ├── sections/
│   │   ├── abstract.tex        # Finalized post-drafting summary
│   │   ├── introduction.tex    # Theoretical framing & research contributions
│   │   ├── related-work.tex    # Comprehensive synthesis + comparison table
│   │   ├── data-and-methods.tex # Reconciled data pipeline & statistical framing
│   │   ├── results.tex         # Re-run benchmark statistics & stability metrics
│   │   ├── discussion.tex      # Cohort separation & demographic insights
│   │   ├── limitations-ethics.tex# Explicit ethical framework & limitation bounds
│   │   └── conclusion.tex
│   ├── figures/                # High-resolution SVG/PDF plots
│   └── data-availability.tex   # Mandatory journal declaration statements
└── analysis/
    ├── 00_dataset_reconciliation.ipynb   # Phase 2: CSV vs. analyzed row diffing
    ├── 01_rerun_pipeline_expanded.ipynb  # Phase 2: Re-execution of 32 pipelines
    └── 02_stability_significance.ipynb   # Phase 3: Bootstrap & ARI stability checks
```

4. IMPLEMENTATION PHASES

Phase 0 — Setup & Co-Author Alignment (Week 1)

- Dispatch the alignment briefing to all co-authors to re-anchor scope on the finished thesis upgrade.
- Confirm Journal of Big Data as primary target with project supervisor (Md. Mamun Hossain).
- Update project tracker and establish LaTeX template repository.

Phase 1 — Literature Consolidation (Week 1)

- Merge and deduplicate PDFs from `literature-reviews/komol/` and `tomal/`.
- Expand `refs.bib` from 42 base entries to ~56–58 comprehensive citations.
- Draft `related-work.tex` featuring a structured comparison matrix detailing dataset size, missingness handling, and clustering strategies.

Phase 2 — Dataset Reconciliation & Pipeline Re-run (Weeks 2–3)

- Execute `00_dataset_reconciliation.ipynb` to resolve the 1,617 vs. 1,797 row discrepancy.
- Re-run all 32 imputation × clustering benchmark pipelines on the validated dataset.
- Regenerate PCA cluster scatter plots and composite ranking metrics.

Phase 3 — Enhanced Statistical Rigor for Q1 Standards (Week 4)

- **Stability Analysis:** Implement bootstrapping across cluster assignments to compute Adjusted Rand Index (ARI) confidence intervals.
- **Uncertainty Quantification:** Report variance across non-deterministic methods (K-Means, DBSCAN).
- **Sensitivity Analysis:** Evaluate balance-metric stability across varying weight allocations (20%, 35%, 50%).

Phase 4 & 5 — Drafting, Review & Journal Submission (Weeks 5–8)

- Draft core paper sections (Introduction through Discussion, Ethics, CRediT statements).
- Execute full numerical audit verifying inline figures against notebook outputs.
- Perform self-plagiarism / thesis-derived submission checks prior to formal portal upload.

5. EXECUTION TIMELINE

Milestone / Phase	Primary Objective	Target Window
Week 1	Phase 0 Alignment & Phase 1 Literature Consolidation	Days 1 – 7
Weeks 2 – 3	Phase 2 Data Reconciliation & Pipeline Re-execution	Days 8 – 21
Week 4	Phase 3 Bootstrapping, Sensitivity & ARI Analysis	Days 22 – 28
Weeks 5 – 6	Phase 4 Comprehensive Manuscript Drafting	Days 29 – 42
Weeks 7 – 8	Phase 5 Co-author Review, Formatting & Formal Submission	Days 43 – 56